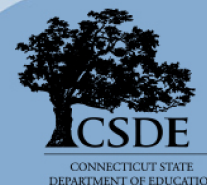


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



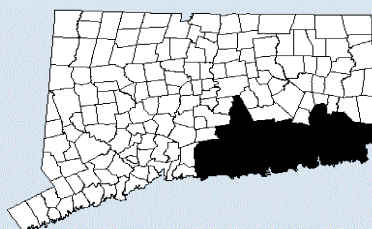
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860-434-4800

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	12
Enrollment	2,359
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$13,613
Total Expenditures ¹	\$34,276,917

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,175	49.8	48.4
Male	1,184	50.2	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	70	3.0	5.2
Black or African American	392	16.6	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	966	40.9	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	195	8.3	4.0
White	720	30.5	49.9
English Learners	213	9.0	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,507	63.9	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	386	16.4	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	307	32.0	*	*
Male	332	35.5	*	*
Black or African American	147	43.5	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	341	43.6	7	0.7
White	103	18.3	*	*
English Learners	110	52.1	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	500	45.7	14	0.9
Students with Disabilities	165	46.1	9	2.0
District	639	33.7	15	0.6
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 372

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	155.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	63.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	39.2
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	80.7
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	8.3
School Level	15.7
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	2.0
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	18.6
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	21.0
School Nurses	8.1
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	147.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.4	0.1
Asian	4	1.5	1.3
Black or African American	11	4.2	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	4.6	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	236	89.4	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	5.4	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	13	*	24	85.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	56	62.9	68	78.2
White	84	88.4	84	97.7
English Learners	*	*	6	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	68	63.6	80	80.0
Students with Disabilities	14	41.2	16	48.5
District	168	76.7	190	87.6
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.5
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	5.8
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.3
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$26,078,708	\$10,357	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$3,083,437	\$1,225	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$8,673	\$3	\$698
Support services - general administration	.	.	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$1,068,306	\$424	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$1,753,754	\$696	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$1,992,387	\$791	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$291,652	\$1,064	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$151
Total	\$34,276,917	\$13,613	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$3,374,986	25.1	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,904,388	14.2	11.1
Other Salaries	\$2,931,245	21.8	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,669,594	19.8	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,752,213	13.0	5.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.5
Supplies	\$37,353	0.3	0.5
Property Services	\$454,655	3.4	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	7.2
Equipment	\$72,576	0.5	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$255,305	1.9	0.1
Total	\$13,452,315	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		39.2	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	59.4
State	35.4
Federal	5.2
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	30	90.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	66	90.9
English Learners	22	90.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	118	90.7
Students with Disabilities	40	75.0
District	218	92.7
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	88.2	74	31.1
Male	80.3	63	31.8
Black or African American	73.9	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	76.7	19	10.8
White	95.6	106	58.6
English Learners	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	79.7	27	13.0
Students with Disabilities	61.2	*	*
District	84.6	137	31.4
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	75.7	76.5
Male	64.8	74.6
Black or African American	66.7	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	60.7	58.5
White	75.3	87.3
English Learners	65.0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	64.8	67.6
Students with Disabilities	55.2	*
District	70.8	75.7
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	33.7%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	43.8%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	82.1%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	31.4%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		90.3%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		92.7%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		92.4%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		70.7%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		52.9%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	92.4%	1.6%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The vision of LEARN is to ensure that every child has access to high quality public education and opportunities through equitable systems of education, support, and service. To achieve this vision, LEARN bases its district improvement planning on the theory of action that if we consciously commit to a social justice stance, develop equity-focused systems, and eliminate inequitable practices, then we will be able to provide equitable access to and opportunities for all students and staff to be successful.

As a mechanism to support continuous improvement, each school utilizes a school development plan. Plans are developed by leadership teams in consultation with all school stakeholders. LEARN school development plans are based on needs assessment data, aligned to overarching district goals, and strive toward the development of school communities that provide physical and emotional safety, high expectations with a growth mindset, and approaches to instruction that foster engaging learning opportunities. The plans clearly articulate action steps and measurable outcomes that directly support every educator's ability to deliver high quality instruction. Interim indicators of progress enable schools to monitor their progress throughout the school year. Data meetings, short-term goal review cycles, and district retreats engage leaders in reflection on the impact of their plans and any necessary adjustments that are necessary.

LEARN teams also work collaboratively with Local Education Agencies (LEAs) to design and implement appropriate special education services to implement students' Individualized Education Plans (IEPs). The development of IEP objectives are based on standards and individual student needs. Data collection systems are designed and implemented in order to inform progress, make revisions to the IEP, and determine supports and services to ensure all learners have access to a Free Appropriate Public Education (FAPE). To ensure all students have the supports they need, interventions for learning and behavior are designed and closely monitored on a systematic basis. Planning and Placement Teams include LEARN administrators, student support staff, parents, and the LEA. All parents and caregivers of children with disabilities have access to LEARN's Student Support Services (SSS) Department. LEARN SSS staff members meet regularly to receive relevant professional development, analyze case studies, and interact in a rich professional learning community.

LEARN is committed to enhancing and strengthening home-school communication and to providing avenues for parental and caregiver involvement. Each LEARN school provides different avenues of communication for families, including handbooks, newsletters, conferences, visitation days, back to school nights, town hall forums, PowerSchool Parent Portal, and School Messenger which translates messages into the language families identify as their primary language during registration. In the 2021-2022 school year, LEARN will be adding a two way multilingual communication tool as an added way to strengthen the feedback and communication loop. All parents and caregivers are encouraged to participate in school level committees to support planning and improvement of school-based programs.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

LEARN, on behalf of districts across the region, successfully serves students from preschool through 12th grade from 81 districts through its six successful magnet schools, including four schools located on the shoreline of southeastern Connecticut: Regional Multicultural Magnet School (K-5); The Friendship School (PK & K); Marine Science Magnet High School of Southeastern Connecticut (9-12); and Three Rivers Middle College (11 & 12). LEARN also partners with Goodwin University in the operation of two magnet schools on the university campus in East Hartford: Riverside Magnet School at Goodwin University (PK- 5) and the Connecticut River Academy at Goodwin University which continues its expansion to a full grades 6-12 model with the addition of a 7th grade class in the 2021-2022 school year. Together, these magnet schools serve approximately 2,500 students, increasing student achievement in racially, ethnically, and socioeconomically diverse communities.

As a magnet operator, LEARN's schools were created, in part, to address the significant opportunity and achievement gaps that exist within Connecticut's communities. Drawing from 81 communities, LEARN's students are brought together to learn with and from one another in diverse classrooms. LEARN schools engage students in culturally relevant curriculum and instructional practices while building strong relationships with and among students and staff. Every LEARN school engages school-based equity teams in continual self-reflection on ways to dismantle practices that may result in racial, ethnic, and economic isolation through the implementation of equity improvement cycles.

As a RESC, LEARN also developed a proposal to and was awarded an U.S. Department of Education Magnet School Assistance Program [MSAP] grant. This MSAP grant, entitled EXPECT, expands student choice through the development and support of a consortia of inter- and intra-district magnet schools across Eastern Connecticut. The grant has a dual goal of reducing minority group and socio-economic isolation throughout the region, as well as increasing student achievement in the participating schools over a 5 year grant period. Through this grant, LEARN is supporting approximately 3,000 students.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

LEARN's schools receive funding from the State Department of Education on a per pupil basis. In addition, each participating district contributes tuition fees. The schools also solicit funds from foundations and grant dollars to supplement educational components. Each school budget is developed by school administration in collaboration with LEARN's central office team. LEARN established the Regional Magnet Advisory Council, which includes Superintendents and district and college leaders from sending towns, to provide input, oversight and to recommend actions to LEARN's Board of Directors. Each school budget is reviewed and approved by LEARN's Board, which is composed of representative members of the Boards of Education of LEARN's member districts, to ensure that each school receives an equitable share. Each inter-district magnet school is funded on a per pupil basis and supplemented with grants such as Title I. The participating schools have the autonomy and authority to allocate resources where they are most needed. Each school is required to consider student learning and social-emotional needs as key priorities, and to develop systems of support to ensure all students thrive.